

Welcome

Survey for Young People

Welcome to our survey on puberty and emotions! We appreciate your help with this research.

You can take breaks or stop doing the survey at any time if you want to.

NOTE: If you start the survey and want to come back later, you can bookmark it in your internet browser and then return to the bookmark on the same device within one week.

Next, you will be given information about the study so you can decide whether you want to take part. It's completely up to you!

We will ask for your age to make sure the information about the study is suitable for you.

Age

How old are you?

PLS

You can access the study information in one of these formats. If you choose video or audio format, you will also be able to download a copy of the written information afterwards.

I would prefer

- ◯ Written study information (read the Plain Language Statement)
- ◯ Video study information (see and hear a person read the Plain Language Statement)
- ◯ Audio study information (hear a person read the Plain Language Statement)

TO: Young people aged 12-14

Plain Language Statement

Date: 30/09/2025
Full Project Title: Influences of puberty on emotions in females with and without ADHD
Student Investigator: Emily Friedel
Principal Investigator: Professor Tim Silk
Associate Investigator: Dr Lisa Grech
Associate Investigator: Dr Nandi Vijayakumar

Invitation

You are invited to participate in this research about how puberty is related to emotions in female adolescents, including those with and without ADHD.

This project is part of Emily Friedel's Doctor of Philosophy (Psychology) course requirements.

Before you decide if you want to participate in this study, it's important that you understand why the research is being done and what you would be asked to do. Please read this information and discuss with other people you trust if you're unsure.

What is the purpose of this study?

Puberty is an important time, and it affects the health and wellbeing of young people. We want to know how puberty might be related to emotions in female adolescents. We also want to know if puberty's influences on emotions differ between those with ADHD and those without ADHD.

Why have I been invited to participate in this study?

You have been invited to participate in this study as a young person aged between 12-17 years whose sex is female (the sex recorded on your original birth certificate is female).

What does this study involve?

If you decide to take part in our study, you will be asked to answer some questions online. This will take about 10-15 minutes.

The questions will ask for information about the following:

- Puberty and changes to your body. For example, if you have started your periods and if you use hormonal birth control.
- Your emotions and moods. For example, if you have very strong emotions or if you have felt unhappy lately.
- Other information about you like your gender identity and if you have ADHD.

Your parent or guardian will also fill out a survey asking for some extra information about:

- Any health conditions you have.

- The way you behave (for example, how you pay attention to things).
- Your mental health.

Note: If you start the survey and want to come back later, you can bookmark it in your internet browser and then return to the bookmark on the same device within one week.

Are there risks and benefits to me in taking part in this study?
You don't get any direct benefits from taking part in this study. But this research will help us understand how puberty might affect the wellbeing of young people with and without ADHD.

You will be asked some personal questions in the survey, which means there is a chance that you might feel distressed or upset. If that happens, you can stop the survey and withdraw without anything bad happening. If you require further support, you can talk to a trusted adult.

Or you can contact Kids Helpline for support:

- Phone: 1800 55 1800
- Webchat counselling service: https://kidshelpline.com.au/get-help/webchat-counselling

You can also contact Emily Friedel (Student Investigator) for further help or ask a trusted adult to do this for you: e.friedel@deakin.edu.au or (03) 9246 8439.

What if I don't want to take part in this study?
You don't have to take part in this study. It's completely up to you, and nothing bad will happen if you don't take part.

What if I participate and want to withdraw?
Any information you put into the survey will be kept by the research team. This means that stopping the survey before finishing will not remove your information.

If you do not want your survey responses included in our study, you can contact the research team. If the study results have not yet been analysed, we may be able to remove your information. If so, we can send a form for your parent or guardian to fill out to withdraw consent. Please note that we plan to start the analysis by 15 June 2026.

But it will not be possible to remove your responses if the results have been analysed. If your responses can't be removed, the research team will let you know.

Ensuring this project is ethical

To do this study, the research team had to get approval from Deakin University (reference number: 2025/HE001102). The University will monitor the study to make sure participants are safe.

To make sure this study is ethical, we have to follow the National Statement on Ethical Conduct in Human Research 2025.

How will my privacy be protected?

We will make sure that no one knows your survey answers belong to you.

Any information you share is confidential, except where the law requires us to tell someone.

Information collected from you will be kept in a safe place at Deakin University for at least 15 years after the youngest study participant turns 18. Then it will be destroyed.

Data from this study that cannot be linked back to you may also be used in future studies that are related to this project or in a similar research area.

We will publish the results of this study in scientific journals and present them at conferences.

If you would like to know what we find, you can enter your email address into a separate link at the end of the survey. Your email address will not be linked to your survey answers.

What should I do if I have questions?

If you would like to ask any questions, please contact Emily Friedel (Student Investigator): e.friedel@deakin.edu.au or (03) 9246 8439.

Who should I contact if I am worried about this study?

If you have any complaints about any aspect of the project, the way it is being conducted or any questions about your rights as a research participant, then you may contact:

Human Research Ethics Office, Deakin University, 221 Burwood Highway, Burwood Victoria 3125, Telephone: 9251 7129, research-ethics@deakin.edu.au.

Please quote project approval number 2025/HE001102.

Thank you

Thank you for considering this invitation. You can download a copy of this information to keep on the next screen.

You can access video study information by clicking this link: Young Person Plain Language Statement Video (12-14 years)

You can access audio study information by clicking this link: Young Person Plain Language Statement Audio (12-14 years)

*** You can download a copy of the study information by clicking this

link: Plain language statement 12-14 years ***

You can access the study information in one of these formats. If you choose video or audio format, you will also be able to download a copy of the written information afterwards.

I would prefer

- ◯ Written study information (read the Plain Language Statement)
- ◯ Video study information (see and hear a person read the Plain Language Statement)
- ◯ Audio study information (hear a person read the Plain Language Statement)

TO: Young people aged 15-17

Plain Language Statement

Date: 30/09/2025
Full Project Title: Influences of puberty on emotions in females with and without ADHD
Student Investigator: Emily Friedel
Principal Investigator: Professor Tim Silk
Associate Investigator: Dr Lisa Grech
Associate Investigator: Dr Nandi Vijayakumar

Invitation

You are invited to participate in this research about how puberty is related to emotions in female adolescents, including those with and without ADHD.

The research is being conducted by Emily Friedel as part of her Doctor of Philosophy (Psychology) course requirements.

Before you decide if you want to participate in this study, it's important that you understand why the research is being done and what you would be asked to do. Please read the following information carefully and discuss it with others if you wish.

What is the purpose of this study?

Puberty is an important time, and it is known to affect the health and wellbeing of young people. We want to know how puberty might be related to emotions in female adolescents and whether this differs between those with ADHD compared to those without ADHD.

Why have I been invited to participate in this study?

You have been invited to participate in this study as a young person aged between 12-17 years whose sex is female (the sex recorded on your original birth certificate is female).

What does this study involve?

If you decide to take part in our study, you will be asked to answer some questions online. This will take about 10-15 minutes.

The questions will ask for information about the following:

- Puberty and changes to your body. For example, if you have started your periods and if you use hormonal birth control.
- Your emotions and moods. For example, if you have very strong emotions or if you have felt unhappy lately.
- Other information about you like your gender identity and if you have ADHD.

Your parent or guardian will also fill out a survey asking for some extra information about:

- Any health conditions you have.
- The way you behave (for example, how you pay attention to things).
- Your mental health.

Note: If you start the survey and want to come back later, you can bookmark it in your internet browser and then return to the bookmark on the same device within one week.

Are there risks and benefits to me in taking part in this study?

Participation in this study does not provide any immediate benefits to you. However, this research will contribute to the understanding of how puberty might impact the wellbeing of young people with and without ADHD.

You will be asked personal questions in the survey, which means there is a chance that you might feel distressed or upset. If that happens, you can stop the survey and withdraw without any negative consequences. If you require further support, you can talk to a trusted adult.

Or you can contact Kids Helpline for support:

- Phone: 1800 55 1800
- Webchat counselling service: https://kidshelpline.com.au/get-help/webchat-counselling

You can also contact Emily Friedel (Student Investigator) for further help or ask a trusted adult to do this for you: e.friedel@deakin.edu.au or (03) 9246 8439.

What if I don't want to take part in this study?

You do not have to participate in this study. It is completely up to you, and you will not be disadvantaged in any way if you decide not to do the survey.

What if I participate and want to withdraw later?

Any information you put into the survey will be collected and may be analysed. This means that if you stop the survey before finishing, your data are not automatically withdrawn.

If you do not want your survey responses included in our study, you can contact the research team. If the study results have not yet been analysed, we may be able to remove your data. If so, we can send a form for your parent or guardian to fill out to withdraw consent. Please note that we plan to start the analysis by 15 June 2026.

However, it will not be possible to remove your responses if the results have been analysed. If this is the case, the research team will let you know.

Ensuring this project is ethical

This study has received Deakin University ethics approval (reference number: 2025/HE001102). The University will monitor the study to make sure participants are safe.

To make sure it is ethical, this study follows the National Statement on Ethical Conduct in Human Research 2025.

How will my privacy and confidentiality be protected?

Your survey responses will be de-identified. This means that there will be no way of knowing which answers are yours when we analyse the survey responses or report the results.

Any information you share is confidential, except where disclosure is required by law (given research data is not privileged data).

Information collected from you will be kept on a secure data repository at Deakin University for at least 15 years after the youngest study participant turns 18. After that, it will be securely destroyed.

De-identified data may be shared with researchers not named on this Plain Language Statement or researchers outside of Deakin University. De-identified data may also be used in future studies that are related to this project or in a similar research area.

Results from this study will be published in scientific journals and presented at conferences.

If you want to receive a summary of the study findings, you can enter your email address into a separate link at the end of the survey (your email address will not be linked to your survey answers).

What should I do if I want to discuss this study further before I decide?

If you would like further information, please contact Emily Friedel (Student Investigator): e.friedel@deakin.edu.au or (03) 9246 8439.

Who should I contact if I have concerns about the conduct of this study?

If you have any complaints about any aspect of the project, the way it is being conducted or

any questions about your rights as a research participant, then you may contact:

Human Research Ethics Office, Deakin University, 221 Burwood Highway, Burwood Victoria 3125, Telephone: 9251 7129, research-ethics@deakin.edu.au.

Please quote project approval number 2025/HE001102.

Thank you

Thank you for considering this invitation. You can download a copy of this information sheet to keep.

You can access video study information by clicking this link: Young Person Plain Language Statement Video (15-17 years)

You can access audio study information by clicking this link: Young Person Plain Language Statement Audio (15-17 years)

*** You can download a copy of the study information by clicking this link: Plain language statement 15-17 years ***

Consent

By clicking 'yes', you agree to the following:

- I understand the study information provided.
- I understand I will be asked to fill out a survey that takes 10–15 minutes.
- I know I don't have to do the survey and can stop at any time.

- ◯ Yes, I would like to participate
- ◯ No, I do not want to participate

Demographics

Thank you for agreeing to do this survey!

Remember you can take breaks or stop at any time.

What is your age in years and months?

Years

Months

Do you have ADHD?

- No
- Yes

What is your gender identity?

- Girl / Woman / Female
- Boy / Man / Male
- Trans / Gender diverse
- Non-binary
- Prefer not to say
- Prefer to self-describe

Puberty

The next questions are about changes that may be happening to your body.

These changes normally happen to different young people at different ages.

Please do your best to answer carefully. **If you do not understand a question or do not know the answer, just mark "I don't know".**

Would you say that your growth in height:

- ○ has not yet begun to spurt
- ○ has barely started
- ○ is definitely underway
- ○ seems completed
- ○ I don't know

And how about the growth of your body hair? ("Body hair" means hair any place other than your head, such as under your arms.)

- ○ has not yet begun to grow
- ○ has barely started to grow
- ○ is definitely underway
- ○ seems completed
- ○ I don't know

Have you noticed any skin changes, especially pimples?

- ○ skin has not yet started changing
- ○ skin has barely started changing
- ○ skin changes are definitely underway

- ○ skin changes seem complete
- ○ I don't know

Have you noticed that your breasts have begun to grow?

- ○ have not yet started growing
- ○ have barely started growing
- ○ breast growth is definitely underway
- ○ breast growth seems complete
- ○ I don't know

Have you begun to menstruate (started your period)?

- ○ No
- ○ Yes

Menstruation

How old were you when you started to menstruate?

Please type in the age you were in years and months to the best of your memory.

Years

Months

What was the date of the first day of your last period?

If you're not sure, just put in your best guess.

Date

Do you use hormonal birth control?

These are any medications designed to prevent pregnancy by changing hormones, but they can be used for other reasons too (like to help with managing periods or skin problems).

** Note that a copper intrauterine device (IUD) is not hormonal birth control, but there are also hormone-based IUDs.

- ○ No
- ○ Yes

Hormonal birth control details

What type of hormonal birth control do you use?

- ○ Oral contraceptives ('the pill')
- ○ Injection
- ○ Implant
- ○ Vaginal ring
- ○ Hormone-based intrauterine device (IUD)
- ○ Other (please specify) [ ]

Please select the type of pill you take from this list:

Azalia
Bella
Brenda-35 ED
Brooke
Brooklyn
Cerazette
Diane-35 ED
Eleanor 150/30 ED
Estelle-35 ED
Evelyn 150/30 ED

When did you first start using hormonal birth control?

If you're not sure, just put in your best guess.

Date

Have you noticed any changes in your moods or emotions since taking hormonal birth control?

If yes, please briefly describe these changes.

- ○ No
- ○ Yes

Break reminder

You are over halfway through the survey!

Remember, you can take breaks or stop at any time. If you are feeling uncomfortable or distressed, please speak to an adult you trust.

If you need extra support, you can call Kids Helpline 1800 55 1800 or use their webchat.

You can also contact a member of the research team (Emily Friedel): e.friedel@deakin.edu.au or (03) 9246 8439

ERS

The next section will ask you some questions about your emotions, moods, and feelings.

Please self-rate based on the following statements, using a scale from 0 to 4, where **0 means 'not at all like me'** and **4 means 'completely like me'**.

	0 not at all like me	1	2	3	4 completely like me
When something happens that upsets me, it's all I can think about for a long time.	○	○	○	○	○
My feelings get hurt easily.	○	○	○	○	○
When I experience emotions, I feel them very strongly/intensely.	○	○	○	○	○

	0 not at all like me	1	2	3	4 completely like me
When I am emotionally upset, my whole body gets physically upset as well.	○	○	○	○	○
I tend to get very emotional very easily.	○	○	○	○	○
I experience emotions very strongly.	○	○	○	○	○

	0 not at all like me	1	2	3	4 completely like me
I often feel extremely anxious.	○	○	○	○	○
When I feel emotional, it's hard for me to imagine feeling any other way.	○	○	○	○	○
Even the littlest things make me emotional.	○	○	○	○	○

	0 not at all like me	1	2	3	4 completely like me
If I have a disagreement with someone, it takes a long time for me to get over it.	○	○	○	○	○
When I am angry/upset, it takes me much longer than most people to calm down.	○	○	○	○	○
I get angry at people very easily.	○	○	○	○	○

	0 not at all like me	1	2	3	4 completely like me
I am often bothered by things that other people don't react to.	○	○	○	○	○
I am easily agitated.	○	○	○	○	○
My emotions go from neutral to extreme in an instant.	○	○	○	○	○

	0 not at all like me	1	2	3	4 completely like me
When something bad happens, my mood changes very quickly. People tell me I have a very short fuse.	○	○	○	○	○
People tell me that my emotions are often too intense for the situation.	○	○	○	○	○
I am a very sensitive person.	○	○	○	○	○

	0 not at all like me	1	2	3	4 completely like me
My moods are very strong and powerful.	○	○	○	○	○
I often get so upset it's hard for me to think straight.	○	○	○	○	○
Other people tell me I'm overreacting.	○	○	○	○	○

SMFQ

These questions are about how you might have been feeling or acting recently.

For each question, please check how you have been feeling or acting **in the past two weeks.**

If a sentence was not true about you, check **NOT TRUE.**

If a sentence was only sometimes true, check **SOMETIMES.**

If a sentence was true about you most of the time, check **TRUE.**

	Not true	Sometimes	True
I felt miserable or unhappy.	○	○	○
I didn't enjoy anything at all.	○	○	○
I felt so tired that I just sat around and did nothing.	○	○	○
I was very restless.	○	○	○
I felt I was no good anymore.	○	○	○

	Not true	Sometimes	True
I cried a lot.	○	○	○

	Not true	Sometimes	True
I found it hard to think properly or concentrate.	○	○	○
I hated myself.	○	○	○
I felt I was a bad person.	○	○	○
I felt lonely.	○	○	○

	Not true	Sometimes	True
I thought nobody really loved me.	○	○	○
I thought I could never be as good as other kids.	○	○	○
I felt I did everything wrong.	○	○	○

End of survey

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